

it. I don't like going to the gym, it's too constrictive," says Bhargava, who uses Surya Namaskar to tone up her body.

During Covid-19 and the subsequent lockdowns, Bhargava even held online yoga classes for the CashKaro employees. "During Covid-19 we started something called the CK morning show. It's a video call. I started hosting it since everyone was working from home and it was a good way to connect. We would celebrate people's birthdays, work anniversaries, etc. I would often share my own experiences regarding yoga, Pranayam, etc., so that everyone could have a good start to the day," says Bhargava, adding that this has made her a more empathetic leader. She also gave tips to strengthen the back using yoga as during work from home, a lot of employees complained of backaches.

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"If there is one thing I wish I had discovered sooner in life, it's yoga," says Bhargava. "Besides health benefits, I realised it helps me manage my time better and has made me a more balanced professional."

Bhargava says CashKaro has benefitted because of the overall growth in online shopping. "We closed FY22 with more than 100 per cent growth in revenue. We have introduced EarnKaro [an affiliate marketing programme]. We have grown from a team of 120 last year to 350 this year, and we hope to close at over 600 employees in March 2023." **BT**

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DANCING TO HER BEAT

Suhasini Sampath, CEO and Co-founder of Yoga Bar, is a trained hip-hop dancer

BY SMITA TRIPATHI



MOVING TO THE MUSIC For Suhasini Sampath, dancing is both a form of exercise and a way to maintain work-life balance

For 38-year-old Suhasini Sampath, CEO and Co-founder of Yoga Bar, a nutrition-led food start-up, music and dance is a way of life. "I am crazy about music. I listen to it all my waking hours," says the accomplished singer who has learnt Carnatic music for over 10 years. However, it is hip-hop that gets her really moving. A trained dancer, Sampath has been moving to the African-American beats for the past decade and a half. "I was exposed to hip-hop music as a child by my parents. Hip-hop is universal. You hear it all over the place, so effectively you can dance anywhere," says the Bengaluru-based entrepreneur. Earlier, she learnt salsa but that is not easy to practise as very few places play salsa music. For the past six years, she has been training under Sridhar Jeeva from Bengaluru-based Hip Hop India.

Sampath practises for two to three hours a week, down from five to six hours earlier. With business expanding,

time has become a luxury. Yoga Bar, which Sampath set up along with her sister Anindita in 2015, has seen over six times growth in the past two years, from ₹33 crore to ₹200 crore. Sampath, who is an alumna of Wharton, hopes to take the company to ₹1,000 crore in the next five years. Currently, Yoga Bar has over 40 products under its umbrella, including protein bars, oats, muesli, etc.

Sampath is also passionate about theatre and was pursuing it actively between the ages 15 and 25. "Maybe I will get back to it when I have more time," she says wistfully.

Dancing and listening to music helps her de-stress. "A sense of balance is important. Days tend to be stressful. It helps maintain a work-life balance and dancing is also a good form of exercise," says Sampath, who is looking at raising funding over the next couple of years to increase distribution. **BT**

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